

InstaDesk

Multi-monitor launcher & window-tiling — User Manual

FcXe Studios · v0.1 · English

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1 • What is InstaDesk?

InstaDesk turns the tedious morning ritual — opening the same apps and dragging every window into place across several monitors — into a single click.

You arrange apps on a visual grid for each monitor, save that arrangement as a **Layout**, and from then on one **Apply** launches every app and tiles it exactly where you put it. You can keep many layouts (work, design, trading, streaming...), bundle several into a **Quick Preset**, or ad-hoc **Snap** a single window into place.

Is it hard? No — the learning curve is quick. But InstaDesk is a power tool with real depth (per-monitor grids, custom launch arguments, browser tab groups). This manual walks every feature; the in-app **Help** tab is the short version.

2 · Core concepts

Five ideas are all you need:

Monitor

You arrange one display at a time. The **Monitor** selector (left panel) chooses which; the **Display Array** shows how your screens are physically laid out.

Grid & cells

Each monitor is divided into a grid of **cells** (e.g. 6×6). You can set a different grid density per monitor.

Region

A rectangular block of cells you assign one app to. A region can be a single cell or a wide band — for example the left half of a monitor.

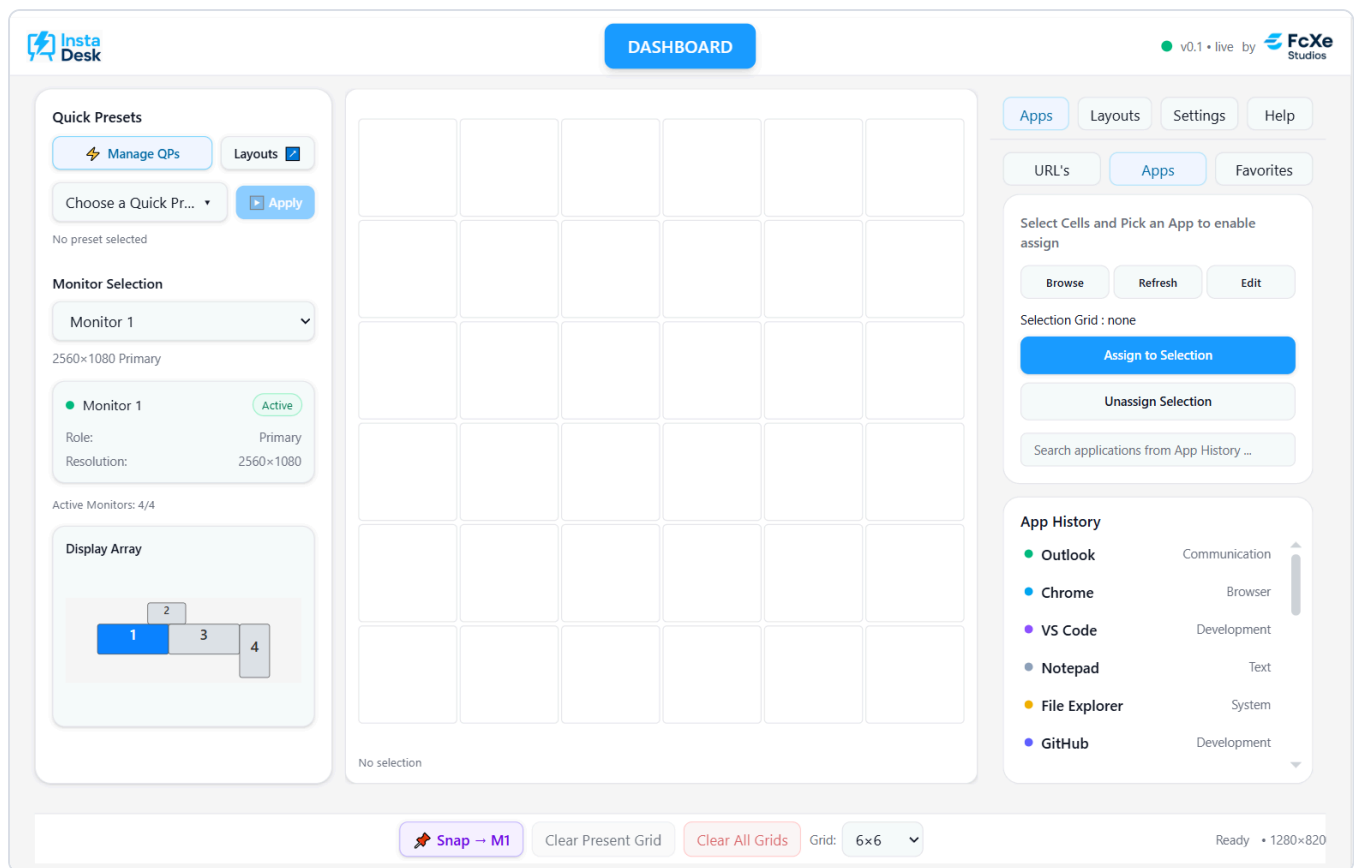
Layout

A saved set of regions across all your monitors — the heart of InstaDesk. Apply it to launch and tile everything.

Quick Preset

A bundle of several Layouts you apply together in one click.

3 · The interface, at a glance



- **Left panel** — Quick Presets, the Monitor selector, and the Display Array.
- **Centre** — the workspace grid for the selected monitor, where you select cells and see assignments.
- **Right panel** — tabs for **Apps**, **Layouts**, **Settings**, and **Help**.
- **Bottom bar** — **Snap**, **Clear Present Grid**, **Clear All Grids**, and the per-monitor **Grid** size.

4 · Quick start: your first layout

1. Pick a monitor in the left panel.
2. In the centre grid, **drag across cells** to select a region (say, the left half).
3. Open the **Apps** tab, choose an app (e.g. Chrome), and click **Assign to Selection**.
4. Select another region and assign a second app. Repeat for other monitors via the Monitor selector.
5. Open the **Layouts** tab → + **New Layout**, pick a slot letter, and save.
6. Click **Apply** on the layout card — InstaDesk launches each app and tiles it into place.

The screenshot shows the InstaDesk dashboard interface. At the top, there's a 'DASHBOARD' button and a version indicator 'v0.1 • live by FcXe Studios'. The left sidebar contains 'Quick Presets' with 'Manage QPs' and 'Layouts' buttons, a 'Choose a Quick Pr...' dropdown, and an 'Apply' button. Below this is 'Monitor Selection' showing 'Monitor 1' as the selected monitor with a resolution of '2560x1080 Primary'. A 'Display Array' diagram shows a 2x2 grid of monitors, with monitor 1 highlighted. The main area is a 6x6 grid of cells. The first 6 columns (left half) are selected and each contains a 'Chrome' app tile. The right half of the grid is empty. On the right sidebar, the 'Apps' tab is active, showing 'URL's', 'Apps', and 'Favorites' sections. The 'Apps' section has a 'Select Cells and Pick an App to enable assign' button, a 'Browse' button, and an 'Assign to Selection' button. Below this is a 'Selection Grid : 18' section with an 'Assign to Selection' button. The 'App History' section lists 'Outlook' (Communication), 'Chrome' (Browser), and 'VS Code' (Development). At the bottom, there's a status bar with 'Snap → M1', 'Clear Present Grid', 'Clear All Grids', a 'Grid: 6x6' dropdown, and a summary '18 cells selected, 18 assigned • 1280x820'.

5 · The grid & assigning apps

Selecting & assigning

Drag across cells to select a rectangular region, then click **Assign to Selection** in the Apps tab. Use **Unassign Selection** to clear it. Regions must be rectangles.

Grid size (per monitor)

The **Grid** selector in the bottom bar sets the density of the *current* monitor — 6×6 for broad zones, 10×10 for fine control. Each monitor remembers its own size. Changing it on a monitor that already has apps asks for confirmation, since it re-shapes that grid.

Custom launch arguments

Give a cell its own launch arguments in the Apps tab — for example a folder path for File Explorer, so two regions open two *different* folders of the same app. This is how you place several distinct windows of one program.

The screenshot shows the InstaDesk Dashboard interface. At the top, there's a 'DASHBOARD' button and a version indicator 'v0.1 • live by FcXe Studios'. The main area is divided into several sections:

- Quick Presets:** Includes 'Manage QPs', 'Layouts', and a 'Choose a Quick Pr...' dropdown with an 'Apply' button. Below this, it says 'No preset selected'.
- Monitor Selection:** A dropdown menu showing 'Monitor 1' with a resolution of '2560×1080 Primary'. Below this, it shows 'Active Monitors: 4/4' and a 'Display Array' diagram with four numbered monitors.
- Grid:** A 6x6 grid of 36 cells, each containing the text 'File Explorer'. Below the grid, it says 'Selected: 0-6 × 0-6 • 36 cells'.
- Apps Tab:** On the right, there's a tab labeled 'Apps' with sub-tabs 'URL's', 'Apps', and 'Favorites'. Below these, there's a 'Select Cells and Pick an App to enable assign' section with 'Browse', 'Refresh', and 'Edit' buttons. Below that, it says 'Selection Grid : 36' and has an 'Assign to Selection' button. Below that, there's an 'Unassign Selection' button.
- Launch Args for Selection:** A section with a 'Reset' button and a text input field containing 'C:\FcXe Studios\Instadesk\instadesk'. Below this, it says 'App default is empty. Whatever you type here is appended to the launch command.' and has an 'Apply' button.
- App History:** A section showing a list of apps: 'File Explorer' (System), 'GitHub' (Development), and 'Stack Overflow' (Development).

At the bottom of the dashboard, there's a bar with buttons: 'Snap → M1', 'Clear Present Grid', 'Clear All Grids', and a 'Grid: 6×6' dropdown. On the far right, it says '36 cells selected, 36 assigned • 1280×820'.

Clearing

Clear Present Grid empties the current monitor; **Clear All Grids** empties every monitor (with a confirmation). Saved Layouts are never affected by clearing.

6 · Apps, URLs & Favorites

The right-panel **Apps** tab has three sub-tabs.

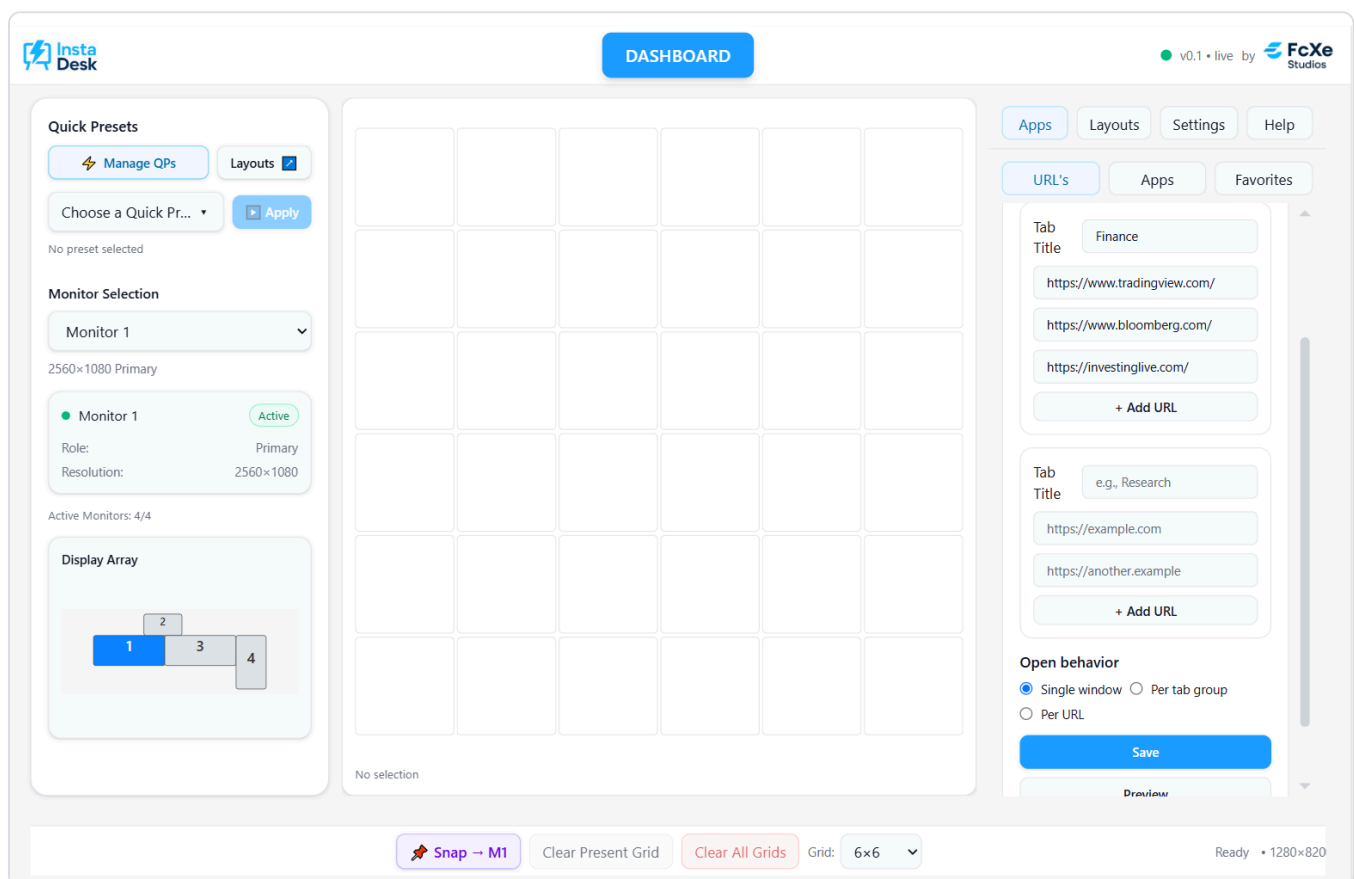
Apps

Pick from the built-in catalog, or click **Browse...** to add any program's `.exe`. Added programs are remembered in **App History** for reuse.

URLs — the URL Builder

Build a group of browser tabs that open together in their own window:

1. Choose a **Browser**. Click **+ Add Browser** to pick from the browsers detected on your PC, or browse for a browser's `.exe`.
2. Add a **Tab Group**, give it a title, and add the URLs.
3. Set the **open behavior** (one window, per group, or per URL) and **Save**. The group then behaves like any app you can assign to the grid.



Favorites

Keep your most-used apps and URLs one click away.

7 • Layouts

A Layout stores which apps go where, across *all* your monitors.

- **Apply** — launches and tiles everything in the layout.
- **Edit** — reopens the layout on the grid so you can rearrange and re-save.
- **Export / Import** — share a layout as a `.json` file.

If a saved app has no program or URL configured, only that one app is skipped on save (with a warning) — the rest of the layout still saves normally.

The screenshot displays the InstaDesk Dashboard interface for managing multi-monitor layouts. The top navigation bar includes the InstaDesk logo, a 'DASHBOARD' button, and the version 'v0.1 • live by FcXe Studios'. The main interface is divided into several sections:

- Quick Presets:** Includes a 'Manage QPs' button, a 'Layouts' tab, and a 'Choose a Quick Pr...' dropdown with an 'Apply' button. It notes 'No preset selected'.
- Monitor Selection:** A dropdown menu set to 'Monitor 1' (2560x1080 Primary). Below it, 'Monitor 1' is listed as 'Active' with a role of 'Primary' and resolution of '2560x1080'. It also shows 'Active Monitors: 4/4'.
- Display Array:** A diagram showing four monitors arranged in a 2x2 grid, numbered 1 to 4.
- Layout A (Main View):** A large grid showing the current layout configuration across four monitors (M1, M2, M3, M4).
 - M1 (2560x1080 Primary, 6x6 grid) contains two 'File Explorer' windows.
 - M2 (1366x768 Secondary, 6x6 grid) contains an 'iVMS-4200 3.6.1.3 Client' window.
 - M3 (2560x1080 Secondary, 6x6 grid) contains a 'VS Studio Code' window.
 - M4 (1080x1920 Secondary, 6x6 grid) contains three windows: 'Crypto Utilities', 'Entertainment', and 'Varios'.
- Layouts Panel (Right):** Contains tabs for 'Apps', 'Layouts', 'Settings', and 'Help'. It features a '+ New Layout' button and an 'Import...' button. Below, it lists 'Layout A' and 'Layout B' with their respective paths and update times. Each layout has 'Apply', 'Edit', 'Export', and 'Delete' buttons.

At the bottom, there is a status bar with a 'Snap → M1' button, 'Clear Present Grid' and 'Clear All Grids' buttons, a 'Grid: 6x6' dropdown, and a 'Ready • 1280x820' status indicator.

8 • Quick Presets

A Quick Preset bundles several Layouts so you can apply them all together with one click — ideal for a full multi-monitor workspace assembled from reusable pieces.

1. Click **Manage QPs** in the left panel.
2. Create a preset and add the Layouts it should include.
3. Back on the main screen, pick the Quick Preset and click **Apply**.

9 • Snap

Snap places a *single, already-open* window into a region — no Layout required.

1. Click **Snap** → **M1** in the bottom bar (the number is the active monitor).
2. A grid popup appears on that monitor.
3. Click a region; the window you last used snaps into it.

Some apps enforce their own position (certain CCTV / video tools) and may refuse to be moved.

10 • Monitors & Settings

Use the **Monitor** selector to switch which display you're arranging; the **Display Array** shows their physical layout. The **Settings** tab offers:

- **Theme** — Light, Dark, or System.
- **Language** — English or Español.
- **Default grid size** — the size new/cleared monitors start at.
- **Window margin** — a bezel-aware gap so tiled windows don't sit under your monitor frames.

The screenshot displays the Insta Desk Dashboard interface. At the top, there's a 'DASHBOARD' button and a status bar indicating 'v0.1 • live by FcXe Studios'. The main area is divided into several sections:

- Quick Presets:** Includes a 'Manage QPs' button, a 'Layouts' dropdown, and a 'Choose a Quick Pr...' dropdown with an 'Apply' button. Below this, it states 'No preset selected'.
- Monitor Selection:** A dropdown menu currently set to 'Monitor 1', showing '2560x1080 Primary'.
- Monitor 1 Details:** Shows 'Monitor 1' as 'Active' with a role of 'Primary' and a resolution of '2560x1080'. It also indicates 'Active Monitors: 4/4'.
- Display Array:** A visual representation of the monitor layout, showing four monitors arranged in a 2x2 grid, numbered 1, 2, 3, and 4.
- Settings Panel (Right):** Contains two main sections:
 - General:** Includes a 'Launch on system start' toggle (checked), a 'Theme' dropdown set to 'System', and a 'Language' dropdown set to 'English'.
 - Grid & Snapping:** Includes a 'Default grid size' dropdown set to '6 x 6' and a 'Window margin' dropdown set to 'Off (0 px)'.

At the bottom, there's a status bar with a 'Snap → M1' button, 'Clear Present Grid' and 'Clear All Grids' buttons, a 'Grid: 6x6' dropdown, and a 'Ready • 1280x820' status indicator.

11 · Tips & troubleshooting

- **An app won't tile.** Some apps (certain CCTV / video tools) place their own windows. Close and relaunch them, or leave them out of the layout.
- **Only one window opens.** Single-instance apps (e.g. Outlook, Teams) open just one window; assigning them to several cells won't create copies.
- **A shortcut won't launch.** Windows shortcuts (`.lnk`) can't be launched directly — point to the real `.exe` in the Apps tab instead.
- **An app fails to launch.** Check its path in the Apps tab and use **Browse...** to correct it.
- **My added browser disappeared / opened the wrong browser.** Use + **Add Browser** and pick a detected browser (or browse to its `.exe`) so InstaDesk has its real program path.